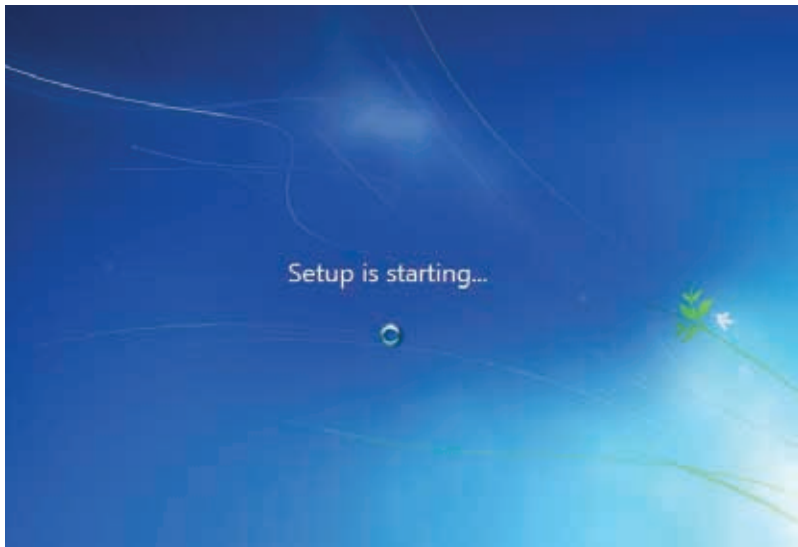


2 Installation



The new setup wallpaper looks pretty good!

Whether you want to set up a dual-boot system, you're ready to migrate all the way to Windows 7 from XP, or something in between, here's what you need to know for installing and playing with Windows 7 and fear not, thy noble purchaser of legal software: its (mostly) painless.

Microsoft offers several paths to install Windows 7. You can upgrade from Windows XP or Vista, or do a clean install on your computer. The clean install process took us exactly 18 minutes on a modestly spec-ed machine and it has been our fastest experience right from Windows 3.1 to a bloated Windows Vista.

The upgrade procedure is different depending on whether you're currently running Windows XP or Windows Vista. Windows 7 provides a direct upgrade path to Windows 7 from Vista. This means that when you install Windows 7, all you need to do is select the Upgrade option during Windows 7 installation. Note: Windows 7 requires that you've installed Vista Service Pack 1 over your base Vista installation in order to upgrade.